

# THE 28-DAY PLAN, WEEK BY WEEK

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Four weeks. Ten minutes a day. The point of a plan is that you stop having to decide anything.

## WEEK ONE - TURNING UP

Three exercises. That is all. You are not trying to achieve anything this week except proving to yourself that ten minutes exists in your day.

**Do these, once a day:** 1. Pelvic Tilt, 2. Single Knee to Chest, 4. Knee Rolls.

**How it should feel.** Easy. If any of the three is uncomfortable, make it smaller rather than skipping it. Nothing this week should leave you sore the next morning.

**What to watch.** Write down where the pain is each day using the letters on the tracker page. You are looking for the letter to start moving back up the alphabet. It may not move at all this week.

**If it flares.** Drop to just the pelvic tilt and start week one again when it settles. Restarting is not going backwards.

## WEEK TWO - FREEING IT UP

Keep week one, add two. You should be noticing something by the end of this week, and what usually changes first is where the pain sits rather than how much of it there is.

**Add:** 7. Seated Nerve Glide (or 8. Standing Nerve Glide if sitting is uncomfortable), 10. Lying Figure Four.

**The nerve glides are the one to be careful with.** They should produce a mild pull and nothing more. No holding at the end, no pushing further, ten smooth repetitions and stop.

**How it should feel.** The figure four should be felt deep in the buttock, not in the knee.

## WEEK THREE - BUILDING

This is where it changes from relief to repair. Stretching settles things down; strength is what stops them coming back.

**On good days:** 17. The Bridge, 18. Bird Dog, 20. Side-Lying Clamshell, plus one stretch from Chapter Three.

**On bad days:** go back to the week one three. Alternating is normal and not a sign of failure.

**How it should feel.** Muscles working, which is a dull honest ache, quite different from nerve pain. If you are getting nerve pain from the strength work, the range is too big.

## WEEK FOUR - WIDENING OUT

Part One three days a week. Part Two on the others. This is the pattern you will keep afterwards.

**Pick your weakest link from Part Two and start there.** Knees if stairs are hard. Balance if you have had a stumble. Core if you sit all day. Posture if you catch yourself rounded forward.

**After week four.** Two or three Part One exercises most days, and one Part Two chapter rotated

# THE 28-DAY PLAN AT A GLANCE

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Four weeks. Ten minutes a day. Tick each day off as you go, and do not worry about the ones you miss.

**Week one - introduce it.** Part One only, Chapter One. Pelvic tilt, single knee to chest, knee rolls.

Once a day. You are not trying to achieve anything this week except turning up.

**Week two - add the nerve work.** Keep week one, add the seated or standing nerve glide and the lying

figure four. Still once a day, still gentle. By the end of this week most people notice the pain has started moving upwards rather than down the leg.

**Week three - start building.** Keep the settling work on bad days. On good days swap to the bridge, bird dog and clamshell, plus one stretch from Chapter Three. Twice a day if it is going well.

**Week four - widen it out.** Part One three days a week, Part Two on the others. Pick a chapter from Part Two that matches your weakest link: knees, balance, middle or posture.

**After week four.** Two or three Part One exercises most days as maintenance, and one Part Two chapter

rotated through the week. Ten minutes. That is the whole thing.

## YOUR PROGRESS TRACKER

Photocopy this page or mark it in pencil. Tick a box for each day you do something, however small.

Three ticks a week beats seven ticks one week and none for a month.

**Week 1** Mon [ ] Tue [ ] Wed [ ] Thu [ ] Fri [ ] Sat [ ] Sun [ ]

**Week 2** Mon [ ] Tue [ ] Wed [ ] Thu [ ] Fri [ ] Sat [ ] Sun [ ]

**Week 3** Mon [ ] Tue [ ] Wed [ ] Thu [ ] Fri [ ] Sat [ ] Sun [ ]

**Week 4** Mon [ ] Tue [ ] Wed [ ] Thu [ ] Fri [ ] Sat [ ] Sun [ ]

**Where is the pain today?** Write B for back only, T for top of the leg, K for down to the knee,

F for down to the foot. Watching that letter move back up the alphabet is the real measure of progress, and it matters far more than how many exercises you managed.

Week 1: \_\_\_\_\_

Week 2: \_\_\_\_\_

Week 3: \_\_\_\_\_

Week 4: \_\_\_\_\_

# TWO PAGES TO TEAR OUT

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These two pages are meant to leave the book. Photocopy them, or tear them out and put them where you

will actually see them: the fridge, the bedside table, the back of a door. The whole point is that on the days you need them most, you should not have to go and find a book and look something up.

## THE BAD DAY CARD

For the mornings when it has flared and you do not know what is safe.

**Do only this. Twice, gently, with a rest between.**

**2a01. Pelvic Tilt** - flatten your back to the mat, hold, release. Ten times.

**2a02. Single Knee to Chest** - one knee in, hold fifteen seconds, swap. Five each side.

**2a05. Prone Press-Up** - forearms down, chest up, hips heavy. Hold ten seconds, ten times.

**Watch the direction.** If the pain moves UP out of your leg, keep going. If it moves FURTHER DOWN,

stop that one.

**Between them:** lie on your back with your knees bent and your feet flat, and breathe. That counts.

**Do not:** sit for long periods, reach for anything on the floor, or decide that today is the day to push through it.

**See a doctor rather than exercise if:** you have numbness around the saddle area, any loss of bladder or bowel control, or sudden weakness in a leg or foot.

## THE TEN MINUTE CARD

For an ordinary day. This is the routine to default to when you cannot be bothered to choose.

**2a01. Pelvic Tilt** - ten

**2a04. Knee Rolls** - five each side, hold fifteen seconds

**2a10. Lying Figure Four** - five each side, hold fifteen seconds

**2a17. The Bridge** - ten, holding eight seconds at the top

**2a07. Seated Nerve Glide** - ten smooth, no holding

**If you cannot get to the floor, use this instead:**

**2a23. Seated Pelvic Tilt** - ten

**2a24. Seated Spinal Twist** - twenty seconds each side

**2a11. Seated Figure Four** - fifteen seconds each side

**2a25. Chair Squat** - eight

**2a08. Standing Nerve Glide** - ten smooth, no holding

**Ten minutes. Most days. That is the whole secret, and there is not a better one being kept from you.**